



SWIM & WATER SAFETY

Health & Physical Education · Year 7–8 · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0

This workbook has **sentence starters**, **word banks**, and **circle choices** to help you. You don't need to write long answers — short, clear answers are great!

MY NAME

CLASS

TEACHER

How This Workbook Helps You

- **Word banks** give you words to choose from — you don't have to think of them yourself
- **Sentence starters** begin the answer for you — just finish the sentence
- **Circle choices** let you circle the right answer instead of writing
- There are no trick questions — your teacher wants to know what YOU think

1 Why Water Safety Matters in Victoria

KEY FACTS — REMEMBER THESE!



52 people drowned in Victoria in 2024–25. That is a LOT of people.



1 in 5 people who drowned were aged 15–24 years old — the same age as you in a few years.



ZERO deaths happened at patrolled beaches or supervised pools. Every single death happened somewhere without a lifeguard.



Males are **4 times** more likely to drown than females.



Most drownings happen at **rivers, dams and lakes** — not at the beach.

Activity 1.1 — About Me and Water

~5 min

Circle your answers:

My favourite water place is:

The beach 🌊

A river or lake 🌳

A public pool 🏊

A backyard pool 🏠

I don't like swimming

How good a swimmer am I?

Still learning

Can swim a little

Good swimmer

Very strong swimmer

Activity 1.2 — Looking at the Data

~10 min

Look at the facts box above. Answer these questions using the word bank to help you.

WORD BANK

patrolled

unpatrolled

lifeguard

54

rivers

dangerous

15–24

males

Question 1

1 mark

How many people drowned in Victoria in 2024–25?

The answer is: _____

Question 2

1 mark

Where did ALL of the drowning deaths happen? Circle the right answer:

At patrolled beaches

At unpatrolled locations

At public pools

At school

Question 3

2 marks

Finish these sentences using words from the word bank:

Most drowning deaths happen at _____ locations because there is no _____ watching.

The most dangerous age group is _____ year olds.

Question 4

2 marks

Why do you think young people are more likely to drown than older adults? Use the word bank. Write **two ideas**:

IDEA BANK

peer pressure

showing off

risky dares

overconfident

no lifeguard

unpatrolled beach

Idea 1: Young people might drown because

Idea 2: Another reason is _____

2 Beach Flags and Rip Currents

KEY FACTS — BEACH FLAGS

 **Red and Yellow flags** = ALWAYS swim here. A lifeguard is watching you.

 **Single red flag** = Dangerous. Only very experienced swimmers should enter.

Black and white squares = For surfboards only. Swimmers must stay out.



 **Yellow with black ball** = Swimmers only. No surfboards.

 **Orange windsock** = Offshore winds. NO inflatable toys — they will blow out to sea.

 **Purple flag** = Dangerous sea creatures (e.g. jellyfish). Be careful.

Activity 2.1 — Name the Flags ★ COLOUR

~8 min

Look at the flags. Write the name of each flag using the word bank below.

FLAG NAME BANK

Red & Yellow

Single Red

Black & White

Yellow + Black Ball

Orange Windsock

Purple



Flag 1:

*I swim here: Yes / No
(circle)*



Flag 2:

*I swim here: Yes / No
(circle)*



Flag 3:

Swimmers: Yes / No (circle)



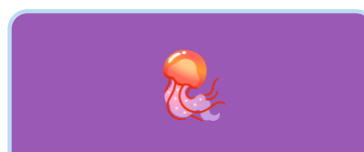
Flag 4:

Surfboards: Yes / No (circle)



Flag 5:

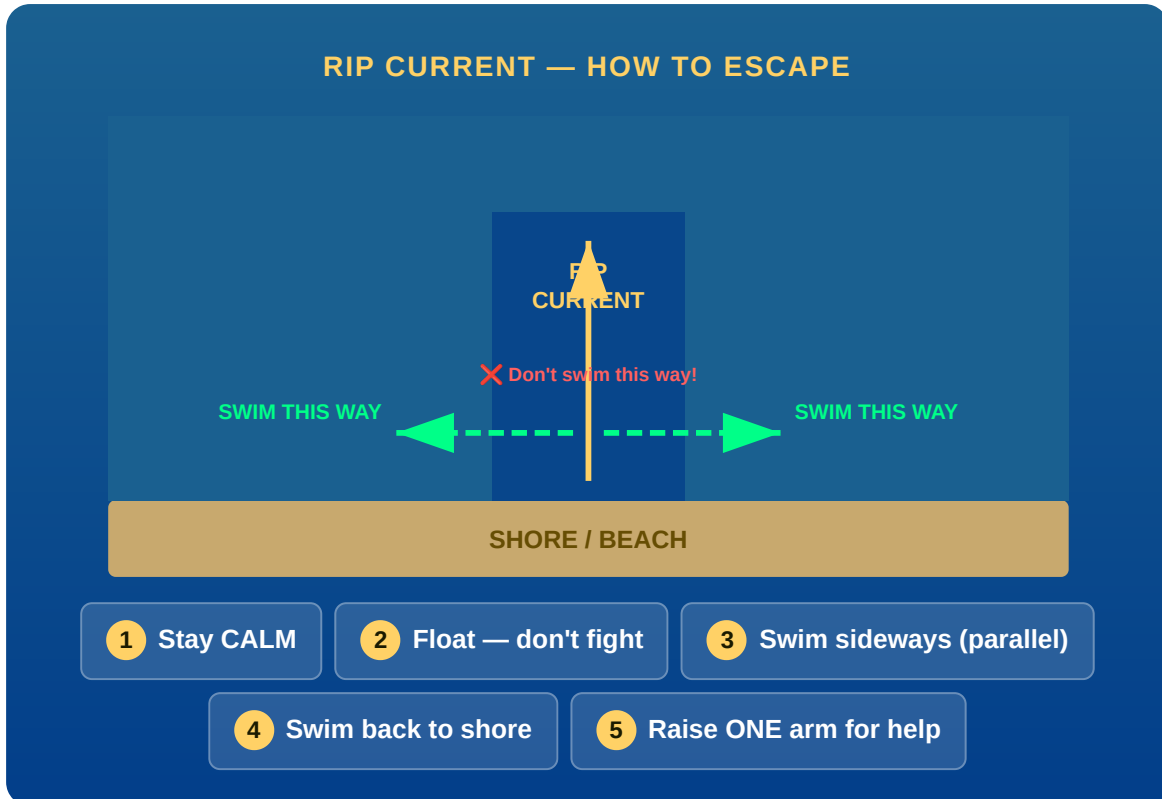
Inflatables: Yes / No (circle)



Flag 6:

Warning about: _____

A **rip current** is fast-moving water that pulls you away from the beach. Look at the diagram carefully.

**Question 2.2a**

2 marks

Look at the diagram. Circle the RIGHT answer:

If caught in a rip, you should swim:

Directly back to shore (fight the current)

Sideways along the shore (parallel)

Straight out to sea

Question 2.2b

2 marks

Write the 5 rip escape steps. Use the steps shown above the diagram:

STEPS WORD BANK

Stay calm

Float

Swim sideways

Swim back

Raise one arm

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Step 4: _____

Step 5: _____

STORY

Liam went to a beach that had no flags. He felt water pulling him away from shore. He panicked and tried to swim back. He got very tired.

Question 2.2c

2 marks

What were TWO mistakes Liam made? Circle your answers:

He swam at a beach with no flags (unpatrolled)

He wore a hat

He tried to swim against the rip (used up all his energy)

He had a friend with him

What should he have done instead? He should have

3

Emergency Response — DRS ABCD

DRS ABCD — WHAT TO DO IN AN EMERGENCY



D = Danger — Check for danger **FIRST**. Is it safe for **YOU** to go near?



R = Response — Tap their shoulder and call their name loudly.



S = Send for help — Call **000** (or tell someone else to call).



A = Airway — Tilt their head back gently to open their airway.



B = Breathing — Look, listen and feel — are they breathing?



C = CPR — 30 chest pushes, then 2 breaths. Keep going until help arrives.



D = Defibrillation — Use the AED machine if one is nearby. It tells you exactly what to do.

THROW, DON'T GO — The Most Important Rule!

If someone is drowning, **DO NOT jump in** unless you are trained. You might drown too! Instead: throw them a rope, towel, pool noodle, or anything that floats. **Call 000 first.**

Activity 3.1 — DRS ABCD Practice

~5 min

Fill in the missing word for each letter. Use the word bank.

WORD BANK

Danger

Response

Send (000)

Airway

Breathing

CPR

Defibrillation

Letter	Word	What you do
D		Check it is safe before going near

R	_____	Tap shoulder and call their name
S	_____	Call 000 immediately
A	_____	Tilt head back to open airway
B	_____	Look/listen/feel — are they breathing?
C	_____	30 chest pushes + 2 breaths
D	_____	Use the AED machine if available

Activity 3.2 — What Do You Do?

Pairs · ~8 min

STORY

You are at a pool party. You look over and see someone floating face-down in the water. They are not moving. You have your phone. There is a rope near the pool edge.

Question 3.2a

1 mark

What is the VERY FIRST thing you do?

Jump in to help

Check for danger first

Run away

Start CPR immediately

Question 3.2b

1 mark

What number do you call?

I call: _____

Question 3.2c

2 marks

Write what you would say to the person who answers the phone. Use this starter:

Hello, I need an ambulance. I am at _____. Someone has _____ . They are / are not (circle one) breathing.

4 Making Safe Decisions Near Water

THE 5 LSV SWMSAFE RULES



Read signs — Always check flags and warning signs before going in the water.



Enter feet first — Never dive head-first into water you don't know. There might be rocks underneath.



Stay in depth — Only swim in water where your feet can touch the bottom (unless you're a strong swimmer).



Swim with a friend — NEVER swim alone. If you get in trouble, no-one will know.



Signal for help — Raise ONE arm above your head if you need help.

Activity 4.0 — Spot the Hazards

Pairs · ~10 min

For each water place, write TWO dangers. Use the hazard bank below.

HAZARD BANK

rip current

no lifeguard

cold water

hidden rocks

strong river current

diving into shallow water

no fencing

submerged logs

Water Place	Danger 1	Danger 2
 Unpatrolled beach		
 River or dam		
 Backyard pool		

Question 4.0a

1 mark

Which place is MOST dangerous? Circle one and explain why:

Unpatrolled beach

River or dam

Backyard pool

I chose this because _____

Activity 4.1 — Safe or Not Safe?

~8 min

For each situation, circle **SAFE** or **NOT SAFE**. Then write what you should do instead.

Situation	Safe?	Better choice:
Swimming at a beach with red and yellow flags	SAFE / NOT SAFE	<i>This is already safe!</i>
Swimming at a river after heavy rain	SAFE / NOT SAFE	
Using an inflatable lilo when the orange windsock is up	SAFE / NOT SAFE	

Going for a swim by yourself in a dam

**SAFE / NOT
SAFE**

Question 4.1a

2 marks

Your friend says "Let's jump in this river — it looks fine!" What could you say? Use this starter:

I would say: "I don't think that's safe because
_____. Let's go to
_____ instead."

5 Rivers, Dams and Cold Water

COLD WATER FACTS



Victorian lakes and rivers can be **very cold** even in summer — sometimes as cold as 12°C!



Cold water makes your body **gasp** — you might accidentally breathe in water.



Cold water quickly makes your muscles **stop working properly** — even strong swimmers can get into trouble.



The safe way to enter cold water: go in slowly, one step at a time. Never jump straight in.

Activity 5.1 — Cold Water and Throw Rescue

~12 min

Question 5.1a

2 marks

What are TWO things cold water does to your body? Circle your answers:

Makes you gasp (breathe in suddenly)

Makes you swim faster

Makes your muscles stop working

Makes you feel more awake and alert

Question 5.1b

1 mark

What is the safest way to enter cold water? Circle the right answer:

Jump straight in from a height

Go in slowly, step by step

Run and dive in headfirst

Throw Rescue — Rank the tools from BEST (1) to WORST (5):

Remember: **Throw, Don't Go** — never jump in if you're not trained!

Tool	My rank (1=best)
Rope with a floating end	
Life ring attached to the jetty	
Jumping in to help them swim	
Throwing a pool noodle	
Holding out a towel from the edge	

Activity 5.2 — Diving and Spinal Injury: What You Need to Know

~10 min

⚠ Important Facts About Diving

- Unsafe diving causes **10%** of all spinal cord injuries in Australia

- The most common victims are **males aged 10–14** — that could be someone you know
- **Two-thirds** of people injured this way are permanently disabled — often unable to move their arms or legs
- A sandbank can form overnight — a place that was safe last week might not be safe today
- **The rule: Feet First, First Time, Every Time** — always go in feet-first before diving anywhere

Three Real Stories — What Happened and Why

Story 1 — Terrigal Wharf, NSW (2025): A teenage boy dived from a wharf and hit the shallow water below. He didn't know how shallow it was. He needed a helicopter to hospital.

Story 2 — Torquay Beach, VIC (2025): A teenage boy dived at a surf beach and seriously injured his spine. A sandbank had shifted and the water was much shallower than he expected.

Story 3 — Bawley Beach, NSW (2024): A young man dived from a jetty he had jumped from before — safely. But a sandbank had formed since his last visit. He was seriously hurt.

Question 5.2a

1 mark

Circle the correct answer: The safest way to enter unknown water is to...

Dive in head-first so you can see the bottom

Go in feet-first every single time ✓

Ask someone if it looks deep enough

Jump from as high as possible

Question 5.2b

2 marks

In Story 3, the young man had jumped from the same jetty safely before. Why was it still dangerous this time?

Question 5.2c

2 marks

Your friend says: *"That river is fine to dive into — we've done it heaps of times."* What would you say back to keep them safe?

6 My Water Safety Plan

Activity 6.1 — My Safety Rules

~10 min

Write down the 5 SwimSafe rules from memory (look back at Section 4 if you need to):

SWIMSAFE RULES BANK

Read signs

Enter feet first

Stay in depth

Swim with a friend

Signal for help

Rule 1: _____

Rule 2: _____

Rule 3: _____

Rule 4: _____

Rule 5: _____

Question 6.1a

1 mark

Which rule is MOST important for you? Circle one and explain:

Read signs

Enter feet first

Stay in depth

Swim with a friend

Signal for help

I chose this rule because _____

Activity 6.2 — My Campaign (Assessment Task)

~20 min · Assessment

Create a water safety message for other kids your age. Choose ONE:

Option A

Design an Instagram post. Draw it or write what the picture and words would say.

Option B

Write a short letter to a Year 5 student about ONE water safety rule they should know.

Planning:

I chose Option: _____

My key message is: _____

One water safety fact I will use: _____

Where I found the fact (website): _____

My draft (write or draw here):

How Did I Go?

Circle: 😞 Not yet / 😊 Getting there / 😄 I've got it!

I know what the red and yellow flags mean



I know how to escape a rip current



I know the DRS ABCD steps



I know all 5 SwimSafe rules



I know why rivers and dams are dangerous



I know Throw, Don't Go



One thing I want to know more about:

© 2026 Emilie Harrison. This resource is licensed under [Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International \(CC BY 4.0\)](https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). You are free to copy, share, adapt and build on it — including for commercial purposes — provided you give appropriate credit and indicate any changes.

Suggested attribution: “Swim & Water Safety Teaching Hub” by Emilie Harrison, licensed CC BY 4.0. Source: emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety

Third-party material is not covered. Content owned by Life Saving Victoria, Royal Life Saving Australia, Surf Life Saving Australia, VCAA, ACARA, AIATSIS, the Australian Resuscitation Council and other organisations — including data, guidelines, logos and program names — remains the property of those owners and is used here for educational purposes. Check directly with the owner before reproducing it elsewhere.

Data sources cited in this resource. Drowning statistics are reproduced with attribution from: Life Saving Victoria. (2025). *Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25*. Life Saving Victoria: Melbourne. Royal Life Saving Australia (2026). *National Drowning Report 2026*. RLSSA: Sydney. World Health Organization (2024). *Drowning — fact sheet*. WHO: Geneva. Surf Life Saving Australia (2026). *Summer Coastal Drowning Report 2025/26*. SLSA: Sydney. These figures remain the property of the publishing organisations. If you adapt this resource, retain these citations.